TaskFlow

how to stop the decline and restore growth

Genesis Strategy & Operations School 2.0
Case Task | March 2026

Recommendation

Do not run a full pivot now.
Narrow the positioning, fix retention, and build around calendar-first planning plus micro-collaboration.

Loom

https://www.loom.com/share/ec723b4fa73542679c644feae340f941

Prepared by

Oksana Kolisnyk

Included in research:
- ready PPTX
- XLSX with calculations
- sources log
- 5-minute Loom talk track

Main recommendation: Turnaround, not full pivot.

Sources: Task brief and own analysis.

Executive summary

The market is still growing. TaskFlow is losing relevance inside that market.

What is broken

The strongest signal is retention erosion: D30 fell from 12.0% to 5.0%, D90 from 6.5% to 2.3%, and paid churn rose to 18%. Acquisition can no longer cover weak product value.

What caused it

No major feature release in 8 months, declining store rating, weak collaboration, no offline mode, repetitive UI, and limited web parity while competitors kept shipping.

Why urgency matters

Downloads and MAU fell 42% in 2025, CPI rose 44%, and burn is ~$150k per month vs $60k MRR.

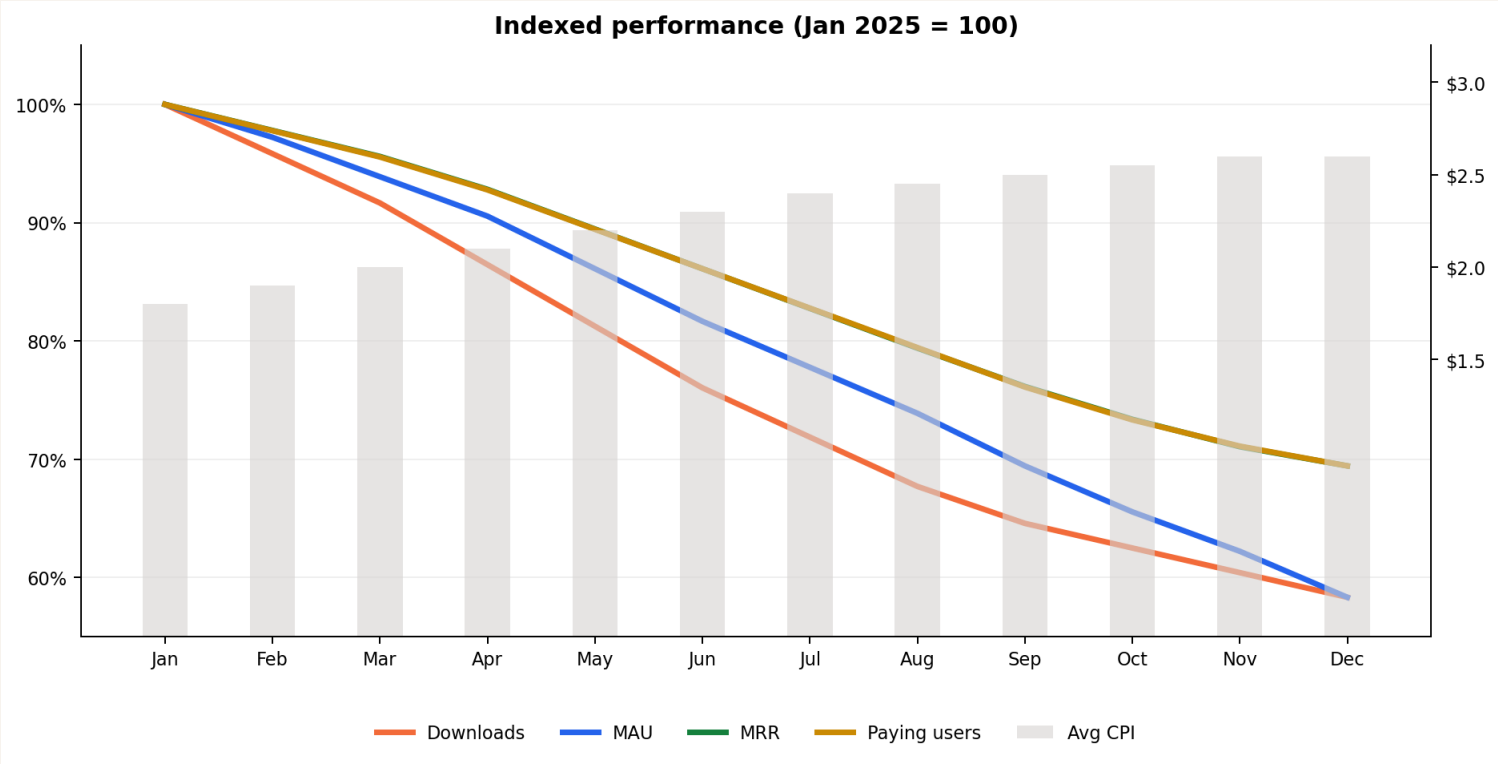
Recommendation

Reposition TaskFlow as a calendar-first planner for young professionals, freelancers and duos. Fix core workflow first, add lightweight AI second, and reduce inefficient paid UA until retention improves.

12-month objective: stabilize MAU by month 6, recover organic share, and bring MRR back to $78k-$85k without a full-scale pivot.

Sources: Task brief; own calculations; Mordor; Gartner; competitor public pages.

2025 performance collapsed across every core metric



Downloads

48k -> 28k
-42%

MAU

180k -> 105k
-42%

MRR

$86.4k -> $60.0k
-31%

Avg CPI

$1.80 -> $2.60
+44%

Sources: Task brief dataset; own calculations.

Diagnosis: this is primarily a product + positioning problem

1. Retention broke first

Every cohort got weaker.
D30 fell 58% and D90 fell 65% vs Q1 2024.
That points to lower repeat value, not just weaker top-of-funnel.

2. Product freshness is weak

Store rating dropped from 4.6 to 4.2.
Public complaints: limited collaboration, no offline mode, repetitive UI.
Last major feature release was 8 months ago.

3. UA became inefficient

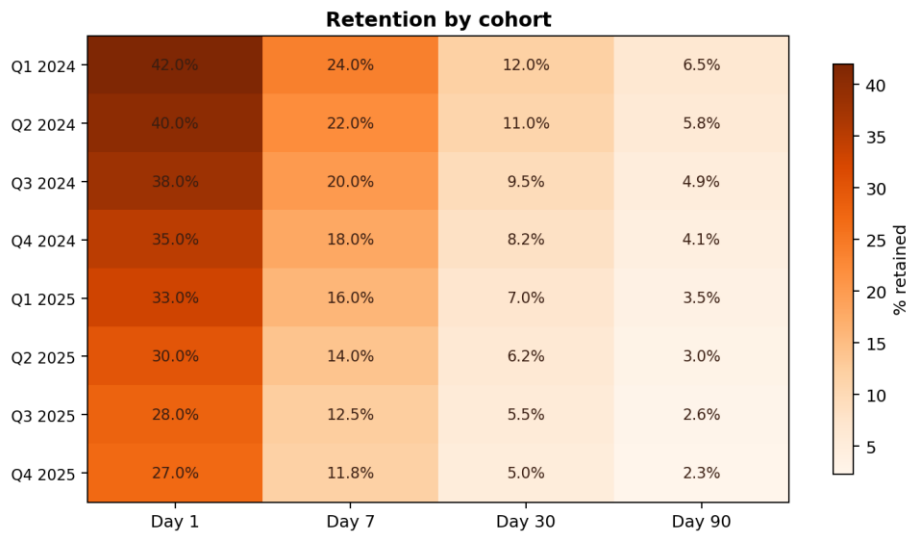
81% of installs come from paid channels.
62% come from Meta alone.
Organic share is shrinking while paid CPI rises.

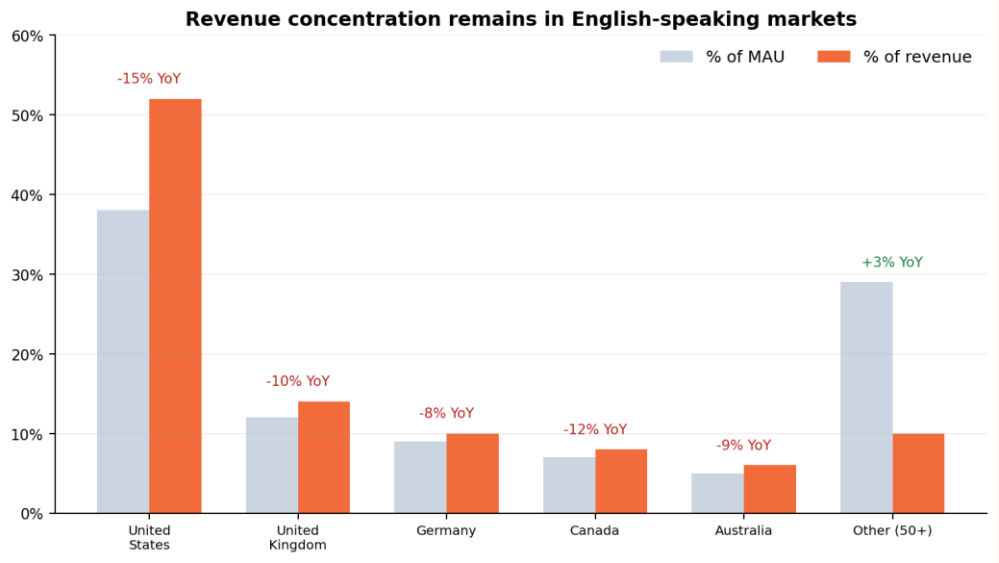
4. Geo mix hurts scale

Best-monetizing markets are shrinking.
Other markets are 29% of MAU but only 10% of revenue.
Cheap growth there will not offset value loss in the US.

Sources: Task brief dataset; public review themes from case prompt.

Unit economics show why scaling paid UA now is dangerous





Approx. paid CAC

$26.5
= $2.60 / 9.8%

Approx. paid LTV

$26.7
= $4.80 / 18%

Implication

At current conversion and churn, a newly acquired payer barely covers expected subscription value before platform fees, fixed costs and reactivation spend.

Secondary insight

LTV fell from roughly $48 in Q1 2024 to about $26.7 in Dec 2025. The monetization engine weakened because users churn faster.

Sources: Task brief dataset; simplified LTV/CAC estimates using provided ARPPU, churn, CPI and free-to-paid conversion.

The market is still attractive, but generic to-do apps are under pressure

Task management market

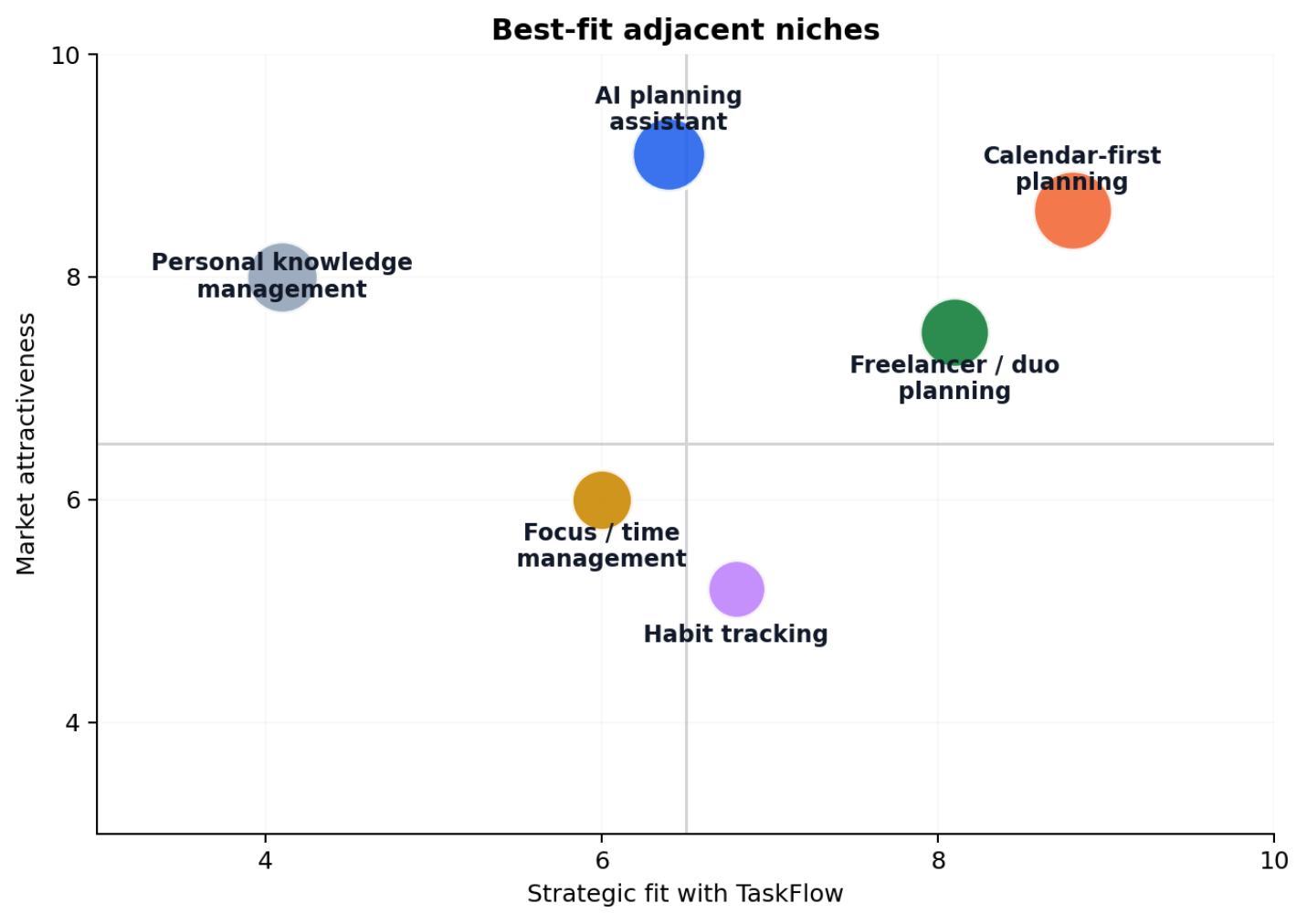
Mordor estimates the task management software market at $1.27B in 2025, growing to $2.66B by 2031 (13.1% CAGR).

Mobile monetization trend

Sensor Tower says non-game app spend reached about $85B in 2025, up 21% YoY. GenAI apps drove a large share of that growth.

Strategic implication

The right move is not to leave productivity. It is to choose a sharper niche where TaskFlow can win with its current team and runway.



Sources: Mordor Intelligence; TechCrunch on Sensor Tower State of Mobile 2026; Gartner AI predictions.

Competitor benchmark

TaskFlow today

Price: $5.99/mo or $39.99/yr
Positioning: generic personal productivity
Main gaps: weak collaboration, no offline mode, stale UX, weak web parity
Signal: 105k MAU, 4.2 rating, no major release in 8 months

Todoist

Price: $7/mo or $60/yr
Why stronger: templates, AI assist, calendar layout, deep integrations
Public signal: 4.6 rating, 297K reviews, 10M+ downloads

TickTick

Price: $35.99/yr
Why stronger: calendar + tasks + habits + Pomodoro in one product
Public signal: 4.6 rating, 157K reviews, 5M+ downloads

Any.do

Price: about $4.99 annual / $7.99 monthly
Why stronger: family + workspace flows, integrations, collaboration depth
Public signal: 4.4 rating, 503K reviews, 10M+ downloads

Microsoft To Do

Price: free
Why stronger: ecosystem bundling with Microsoft / Outlook and zero-price entry
Public signal: 4.6 rating, 468K reviews, 10M+ downloads

Observed GTM is an informed inference from pricing pages, store traction, integrations, templates and ecosystem distribution.

Sources: Todoist, TickTick, Any.do and Microsoft To Do official pages + Google Play listings.

What competitors do better - and where TaskFlow still has whitespace

More complete workflow

Todoist and TickTick cover capture, planning, reminders, comments, templates and advanced views inside one product.

Deeper collaboration

Any.do teams, TickTick shared lists and Todoist workspaces all go beyond TaskFlow's cap of 3 collaborators and limited assignment model.

Stronger distribution

Leaders lean on SEO, templates, ecosystems, app-store scale and integrations. TaskFlow depends too heavily on paid social.

Fresher product

Competitors were updated in March 2026 or late February 2026. TaskFlow's last major launch was 8 months ago.

Whitespace to pursue

TaskFlow should not try to out-feature everyone. The most credible opening is a lightweight, calendar-first planner for solo professionals, freelancers and duos that is faster, cleaner, offline-capable and better for micro-collaboration.

Sources: Competitor public pages and store listings; case prompt review themes.

Strategic options

1. Core turnaround + sharper positioning

Why it could work
Fixes the actual problem: retention, stale UX, weak collaboration and packaging.

Main risk
Still a crowded category. Requires focus and scope discipline.

Investment / impact
Medium investment, medium-high impact.

2. Pivot to AI-first planning assistant

Why it could work
Aligns with the fastest growth theme in productivity and could create stronger differentiation.

Main risk
High execution risk, AI cost and stronger incumbents.

Investment / impact
High investment, high but uncertain upside.

3. Growth-first expansion to lower-cost segments

Why it could work
Can restore top-of-funnel volume and reduce headline CPI.

Main risk
Does not solve retention and may worsen monetization mix.

Investment / impact
Medium investment, low-medium impact.

Why option 1 wins

It addresses the real problem fastest, fits the 12-person team, and preserves strategic flexibility if the product still underperforms after 2-3 quarters.

Sources: Own strategic evaluation based on task brief, market data and competitor benchmark.

Recommended strategy: narrow and modernize the core product

Product

Ship offline mode.
Improve onboarding by use case.
Refresh UI.
Upgrade recurring tasks and calendar parity.
Expand collaboration from 3 to 5 users with comments + attachments.

Positioning

Move from generic to-do app to:
calendar-first planner for young professionals, freelancers and duos.
That is narrower, more defensible and closer to current strengths.

Packaging

Keep pricing broadly stable.
Relax free limits so users can form a habit.
Test 14-day trial, annual-first CTA and win-back offers instead of a blanket price cut.

Growth

Pause or cut underperforming paid social.
Rebuild ASO.
Launch templates, referral loops and creator partnerships in the productivity niche.

Markets

Prioritize US, UK, Canada and Australia first.
Germany can be wave 2.
Do not chase cheap low-monetization volume before retention recovers.

This is a turnaround strategy with a lightweight AI layer, not a risky full pivot into a brand-new product.

Sources: Own recommendation based on brief, benchmark and market research.

12-month roadmap

Q2 2026 | Stabilize

Cut inefficient paid UA
Offline mode MVP
Onboarding by use case
Design refresh
Review-response program

Q3 2026 | Differentiate

Collaboration 2.0
Web + calendar parity
Recurring task improvements
Free tier / trial experiments

Q4 2026 | Add AI selectively

AI smart scheduling
Natural-language capture
Weekly planning summary
ASO + SEO landing pages

Q1 2027 | Scale winners

Increase spend only on positive-payback channels
Referral / ambassador engine
Wave-2 localization if KPIs hold

Decision gate: if D30 retention is still below 7% after Q3 2026, revisit a larger pivot instead of scaling spend.

Sources: Own roadmap recommendation.

What success should look like after 12 months

Metric	Baseline (Dec 2025)	12M target
D30 retention	5.0%	8.0%-9.0%
Paid churn	18%	11%-12%
Trial-to-paid	18%	24%-26%
Organic share of installs	15%	25%
MAU	105k	120k-130k
MRR	$60k	$78k-$85k

Why these targets matter

They focus on proving product value first, then monetization and efficient growth. MAU alone is not enough.

Financial logic

If churn normalizes and organic share recovers, TaskFlow can grow MRR without going back to heavy, low-quality paid social.

Operating rule

Do not scale any channel unless it shows positive payback under the new retention baseline.

Sources: Own KPI targets built from current baseline and recommended roadmap.

Key risks and mitigations

Execution bandwidth

Risk: A 12-person team cannot run five major bets at once.
Mitigation: Freeze non-core work and focus on 3 product bets max: offline, collaboration, onboarding.

Competitive response

Risk: Leaders can copy surface features quickly.
Mitigation: Compete on a sharper use case and workflow simplicity, not feature count.

AI cost / hype risk

Risk: AI can burn time and cash without improving retention.
Mitigation: Add lightweight AI only after core workflow fixes land; use opt-in features first.

Runway pressure

Risk: Burn is high relative to MRR.
Mitigation: Cut inefficient paid UA immediately and gate later spend behind retention milestones.

Geo distraction

Risk: Cheap installs in low-value markets can create false confidence.
Mitigation: Prioritize high-ARPU English markets until the model stabilizes.

Sources: Own risk assessment.

Selected sources and submission note

Sources (titles)

1. Mordor Intelligence - Task Management Software Market
2. TechCrunch on Sensor Tower State of Mobile 2026
3. Gartner - mobile app usage to decrease 25% by 2027
4. Gartner - 40% of enterprise apps to feature AI agents by 2026
5. Todoist pricing update + Google Play
6. TickTick upgrade + Google Play
7. Any.do pricing/help/blog + Google Play
8. Microsoft To Do official page + Google Play

Links

- https://www.mordorintelligence.com/industry-reports/task-management-software-market
- https://techcrunch.com/2026/01/21/consumers-spent-more-on-mobile-apps-than-games-in-2025-driven-by-ai-app-adoption/
- https://www.gartner.com/en/newsroom/press-releases/2025-01-15-gartner-predicts-mobile-app-usage-will-decrease-25-percent-due-to-ai-assistants-by-2027
- https://www.gartner.com/en/newsroom/press-releases/2025-08-26-gartner-predicts-40-percent-of-enterprise-apps-will-feature-task-specific-ai-agents-by-2026-up-from-less-than-5-percent-in-2025
- https://www.todoist.com/pricing
- https://www.todoist.com/help/articles/todoist-pro-plan-pricing-update-bxBvHZuJZ
- https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.todoist&hl=en&gl=US
- https://ticktick.com/upgrade

How to act

TaskFlow should stay in the productivity category, avoid a risky full pivot for now, and focus on restoring product value, sharper positioning, and more efficient growth.

Sources: Full source log will also be included later in the workbook and sources.md: https://github.com/TEZv/Genesis-Academy_Strategy-Operations-School-2.0-Case-Task/tree/main